DOGPLANLAB · PRINTABLE IMPLEMENTATION KIT

Puppy Schedule Starter Kit

Printable schedules, charts & trackers — from wake-up to bedtime.

Everything in this kit comes from dogplanlab.com's puppy schedule guides — reformatted to live on your refrigerator, not on your phone. Print it, check things off, and always know what comes next.

HOW TO USE THIS KIT

Print pages 2–6 for the fridge. Print pages 8–9 fresh each week.

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Free from DogPlanLab · dogplanlab.com — the full guides behind every page in this kit.

Daily Puppy Routine Chart

Example day for a puppy around 8–12 weeks. Move every time to fit your wake time — the pattern is what matters, not the clock.

THE LOOP: wake → potty → eat or play → short activity → nap → repeat

✓	Time	What happens
☐	**6:30 AM**	Wake up — straight outside to potty
☐	**6:45 AM**	Breakfast
☐	**7:00 AM**	Potty again, then play or short training (5–10 min)
☐	**7:45 AM**	Nap (enforced — not just a quiet room)
☐	**9:30 AM**	Wake, potty, short play
☐	**10:00 AM**	Nap
☐	**12:00 PM**	Wake, potty, lunch, short training
☐	**12:45 PM**	Nap
☐	**2:30 PM**	Wake, potty, play
☐	**3:15 PM**	Nap
☐	**5:00 PM**	Wake, potty, dinner
☐	**5:30 PM**	Family time, gentle play
☐	**7:00 PM**	Potty, calm wind-down (chew toy, low activity)
☐	**8:30 PM**	Final potty break ("last call")
☐	**9:00 PM**	Bedtime

- Overnight breaks are normal at this age — many puppies begin sleeping longer stretches around 4–5 months. Don't rush it.
- Full guide: dogplanlab.com/puppy-schedule/

Disclaimer: Example routine, not a prescription. Adjust to your puppy and your vet's guidance.

8-Week Puppy Schedule

Mostly sleep, very short awake windows. Expect to be "on shift" most of the day — that's normal.

KEY FACTS (8 WEEKS)

- **Meals:** 3–4 small meals/day (the AKC calls four "usually adequate"; some guides say three)
- **Potty:** after every wake-up, meal, and play session — plus roughly every 1–2 hours when awake
- **Training:** bursts of 2–3 minutes, a few times a day
- **Sleep:** most of the day; short awake windows are normal

Time	What happens
6:30 AM	Wake up, straight outside to potty
6:45 AM	Breakfast (meal 1)
7:00 AM	Potty again, then a few minutes of gentle play
7:30 AM	Enforced nap (crate or pen)
9:30 AM	Wake, potty, tiny training burst (name, sit)
10:00 AM	Nap
12:00 PM	Wake, potty, lunch (meal 2)
12:30 PM	Potty, calm exploration or chew toy
1:00 PM	Nap
3:00 PM	Wake, potty, short play
3:30 PM	Meal 3, then potty
4:00 PM	Nap
5:30 PM	Wake, potty, dinner (meal 4 — or meal 3 if on three meals)
6:00 PM	Potty, gentle family time
7:30 PM	Wind-down begins: low energy, chew toy
8:30 PM	Final potty break
9:00 PM	Bedtime (overnight outings are normal at this age)

- Bladder control: as a rough rule of thumb, about an hour per month of age (some sources say plus one hour) is cited as a maximum — never a target. Waking, drinking, play, or excitement can mean a trip within minutes.
- Full guide: dogplanlab.com/puppy-schedule/by-age/#8-weeks

Disclaimer: Example day. Your puppy's signals matter more than the clock. Confirm vaccine timing with your vet.

10-Week Puppy Schedule

Like the 8-week day, with slightly longer stretches between naps and potty breaks — and training starts to click.

KEY FACTS (10 WEEKS)

- **Meals:** 3–4/day (same as 8 weeks)
- **Potty:** same trigger moments, slightly longer gaps between the "in-between" breaks
- **Training:** 5-minute sessions, a few times a day, become genuinely productive
- **Vaccines:** second core dose typically due in the 10–12 week window — confirm with your vet before expanding outings

Time	What happens
6:30 AM	Wake up, straight outside to potty
6:45 AM	Breakfast (meal 1)
7:00 AM	Potty, then 5-minute training session (sit, name, come)
7:30 AM	Nap
9:30 AM	Wake, potty, play or short training
10:15 AM	Nap
12:00 PM	Wake, potty, lunch (meal 2)
12:30 PM	Potty, calm socialization (new sound, surface, or visitor at home)
1:15 PM	Nap
3:00 PM	Wake, potty, play
3:30 PM	Meal 3, then potty
4:15 PM	Nap
5:30 PM	Wake, potty, dinner (meal 4 — or meal 3 if on three meals)
6:00 PM	Potty, family time and gentle play
7:30 PM	Wind-down: low energy, chew toy
8:30 PM	Final potty break
9:00 PM	Bedtime (many 10-week-olds still need overnight outings)

- If your puppy consistently leaves food, that's a readiness signal for the 3–6-month meal transition conversation with your vet — not a cue to change anything yet.
- Full guide: dogplanlab.com/puppy-schedule/by-age/#10-weeks

Disclaimer: Example day. Your puppy's signals matter more than the clock. Confirm vaccine timing with your vet.

12-Week Puppy Schedule

Roomier days, teething begins, and the 4→3 meal question arrives.

KEY FACTS (12 WEEKS)

- **Meals:** 3–4/day — many puppies begin transitioning to 3 sometime between 3 and 6 months (readiness + vet go-ahead, not the calendar)
- **Potty:** gradually longer gaps as reliability improves
- **Teething:** permanent teeth begin erupting (~12–16 weeks) — chew toys become essential
- **Training:** 5–10 minute sessions now work well
- **Vaccines:** further along the series (leptospirosis, now considered core by AAHA, isn't started before 12 weeks) — but "further along" isn't "fully protected"; confirm with your vet

Time	What happens
6:30 AM	Wake up, straight outside to potty
6:45 AM	Breakfast
7:00 AM	Potty, then 5–10 minute training session
7:45 AM	Nap
10:00 AM	Wake, potty, play + calm socialization outing (vet-approved)
11:00 AM	Nap
12:30 PM	Wake, potty, lunch
1:00 PM	Potty, chew-toy time (teething management)
1:30 PM	Nap
3:30 PM	Wake, potty, play or training
4:30 PM	Nap
5:30 PM	Wake, potty, dinner
6:00 PM	Potty, family time
7:30 PM	Wind-down: calm activity, chew toy
8:30 PM	Final potty break
9:00 PM	Bedtime

MEAL TRANSITION:
Moving from 4 meals to 3: redistribute one meal's portion across the other three over several days — only on your vet's go-ahead.

- Full guide: dogplanlab.com/puppy-schedule/by-age/#12-weeks

Disclaimer: Example day. Your puppy's signals matter more than the clock. Confirm vaccine timing with your vet.

Feeding + Potty: The Paired Schedule

The rule everything hangs on: predictable meals produce predictable potty.

Every meal is followed by an outside trip about 10–20 minutes later. Every wake-up, play session, and 1–2 hour gap gets one too.

FEEDING DISCIPLINE CHECKLIST

- [ ] Same meal times every day, 7 days a week
- [ ] Bowl down 15–20 minutes, then up (grazing makes potty timing much harder to predict)
- [ ] Same spot, same routine, same path outside afterward
- [ ] Log for 3–4 days: what time each meal ended → when poop followed (your puppy's personal window is the most useful number in this kit)

PAIRED MINI-CHART

Meal	Example time	Potty follow-up
Breakfast	6:45 AM	Outside ~7:00 AM (poop window: about 10–20 min after the meal)
Lunch	12:00 PM	Outside ~12:20 PM
Afternoon meal	3:30 PM	Outside ~3:45 PM
Dinner	5:30 PM	Outside ~5:50 PM

MEALS BY AGE

- 6–12 weeks: **3–4/day** (AKC: four "usually adequate"; some guides: three)
- 3–6 months: **3/day** (transition sometime in this window, readiness-based)
- 6–12 months: **2/day**

Your vet may adjust for breed size and the individual puppy.

My puppy's meal times: Meal 1 _____ Meal 2 _____ Meal 3 _____ Meal 4 _____

- Pee timing stays event-driven (wake, play, excitement, every 1–2 hours when awake) no matter how regular meals get.
- Full guide: dogplanlab.com/potty-training/schedule/

Disclaimer: General guidance. Confirm feeding plans with your vet.

Small-Breed Adjustments

Same loop, tighter spacing. You don't need a different schedule — just these adjustments.

	Standard puppies	Small / toy breeds
Meals/day (8–12 wks)	3–4	4–5 small meals (per Chewy's vet-reviewed feeding guide)
Meals/day (3–6 mo)	3 → 2	3, dropping to 2 around 6 months
Potty breaks (very young)	Every 1–2 hrs	Every 1–2 hrs when very young — plan on at least as many trips as for a larger puppy, and let your puppy's signals set the pace
House-training timeline	Varies by puppy	Varies by individual puppy; small and toy breeds are often slower to become fully reliable — patience, not punishment
Kibble	Standard	Small-sized kibble for tiny mouths; follow the bag's chart for amounts and check food choice with your vet

IMPORTANT · HYPOGLYCEMIA (LOW BLOOD SUGAR) IN TOY BREEDS

Toy-breed puppies can be prone to hypoglycemia (low blood sugar) if meals are missed or spaced too far apart — this is the medical reason for frequent small meals. Warning signs include wobbliness, lethargy, or disorientation. Treat it as urgent: contact your vet. Meal frequency for toy breeds is a vet conversation.

- Water: offer freely during the day; never restrict water as a training shortcut. Ask your vet about evening water timing.
- Full guide: dogplanlab.com/puppy-schedule/ (small-breed section)

Disclaimer: If your puppy seems wobbly, lethargic, or disoriented, contact your veterinarian promptly.

7-Day Potty Tracker & Accident Log

Week starting: _____

Log for a week. The pattern appears — you'll start seeing it too.

HOW TO USE THIS TRACKER

1. Mark every outside trip: time, P (pee), Po (poop), or A (accident inside).
2. Note what happened right before: W (woke up), M (meal), P (play), number = hours since last trip.
3. After 3–4 days, circle your puppy's personal post-meal poop window.

Time	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
6–9 AM							
9–12 PM							
12–3 PM							
3–6 PM							
6–9 PM							
Night							

Key: P = pee outside · Po = poop outside · A = accident inside · W/M/P = what happened before.

(Continued on Page 9: Accident Log & Weekly Review→)

Disclaimer: A tracking tool, not a medical device. Frequent accidents despite a consistent routine for a week+ — or straining, very frequent small-amount urination, or blood — warrant a vet check.

7-Day Potty Tracker & Accident Log

Log for a week. The pattern appears — you'll start seeing it too.

ACCIDENT LOG Every indoor accident goes here — not to grade yourself, but to spot the trigger that preceded it.

Day	Time	Where	What happened before?	What I'll change

WEEKLY REVIEW (END OF WEEK)

- ☐ My puppy's post-meal poop window is about _____ minutes.
- ☐ Accidents happen most often when: _____
- ☐ Next week's one change: _____

- Full guide: dogplanlab.com/potty-training/schedule/

Disclaimer: A tracking tool, not a medical device. Frequent accidents despite a consistent routine for a week+ — or straining, very frequent small-amount urination, or blood — warrant a vet check.

Bedtime Routine Checklist

The last 90 minutes, in order. Calm evenings make calm nights.

Our bedtime: _____ *(Shift the times below to match your household's actual bedtime)*

- [ ] **7:00 PM — Potty.**
  Last big play session ends; outside trip.

- [ ] **7:15 PM — Wind-down begins.**
  Lower the energy in the house: dim lights, calm voices, chew toy instead of fetch.

- [ ] **7:30 PM — Final water check.**
  (Ask your vet about evening water timing for your puppy.)

- [ ] **8:00 PM — Quiet together time.**
  Couch, crate nearby, boring is good.

- [ ] **8:30 PM — "Last call."**
  Final outside trip: same time nightly, no play, minimal talking, straight back inside.

- [ ] **9:00 PM — Bedtime.**
  Crate or pen, familiar blanket, white noise if it helps.

- [ ] **Overnight (if needed).**
  Young puppies may need overnight outings — keep any trip as dull as possible: no play, minimal talking, straight back to bed.

- Many puppies begin sleeping longer stretches around 4–5 months. It's puppy-led, not trained.
- Full guide: dogplanlab.com/puppy-schedule/evening-routine/

What Changes as Your Puppy Gets Older

The loop never changes. The spacing inside it does.

Age	Meals/day	Potty breaks (awake)	Naps	What's new
8–10 weeks	3–4	After every wake, meal, play + every 1–2 hrs	4+ short naps	Everything is new; you're "on shift"
10–12 weeks	3–4	Slightly longer gaps	3–4 naps	5-min training clicks; 2nd vaccine window
12–16 weeks	3–4 → 3 (transition)	Gradually longer gaps	2–3 naps	Teething (~12–16 wks); ask vet about 4→3 meals
4–6 months	2–3	Longer gaps; reliability-based	1–2 rests	Longer training sessions; 3→2 meals ~6 months

Typical patterns — your puppy's actual day is the real guide, not this table.

MILESTONE CHECKLIST (CHECK OFF AS YOUR PUPPY GROWS)

- ☐ Sleeping longer stretches at night (~4–5 months for many puppies)
- ☐ Down to 3 meals (sometime in the 3–6 month window, vet-guided)
- ☐ Teething winding down, adult teeth settling (~6 months)
- ☐ Reliably signaling to go out

- Ranges, not rules. Your puppy's signals and your vet's guidance beat any chart.
- Full guide: dogplanlab.com/puppy-schedule/by-age/

Disclaimer: General developmental patterns. Vaccine and feeding-transition timing: confirm with your vet.

Make It Yours

Fill this in, stick it on the fridge next to the chart.

Puppy's name: _____

Breed / expected adult size: _____

Gotcha day: _____

Our wake time: _____

Meal times: _____ _____ _____ _____

Meal 1 Meal 2 Meal 3 Meal 4

Vet name + number: _____

Emergency vet number: _____

Our one rule for the whole household: *(e.g., "everyone uses the same potty spot")*

_____

"You know more than you think you do. The fact that you printed this proves it." — DogPlanLab